

Elon Musk-led SpaceX's first week as a public company sparks market mania

By Reuters

June 22, 2026 6:59 PM GMT+8 · Updated June 22, 2026

Aa



Birds fly past a SpaceX advertisement outside the Nasdaq MarketSite, on the day of SpaceX's initial public offering (IPO), in New York City, U.S., June 12, 2026. REUTERS/David Dee Delgado [Purchase Licensing Rights](#)

Summary

Companies

- Shares jumped 19% in June 12 Nasdaq debut after record \$75 billion offering
- The surge lifted SpaceX's valuation above \$2 trillion despite the company being unprofitable
- Retail traders bought millions of dollars of shares last week

June 22 (Reuters) - SpaceX's record-breaking IPO fueled a trading frenzy in its first week as a public company, with its shares surging as retail investors and options traders rushed to bet on the Elon Musk-steered rockets-to-AI firm.

Its shares ([SPCX.O](#)) have jumped nearly 40% from its June 12 IPO price of \$135, pushing its market value above \$2 trillion as it briefly joined the ranks of the world's top five most valuable companies.

Jumpstart your morning with the latest legal news delivered straight to your inbox from The Daily Docket newsletter. Sign up [here](#).

Advertisement - Scroll to continue

AD

Here's a look at how SpaceX has fared since its IPO:

HOW DAY ONE WENT

SpaceX's shares jumped 19% in their [Nasdaq debut](#) on June 12, when it raised more than \$75 billion in a record offering. The share pop vaulted its valuation past the \$2 trillion mark to make it the sixth-biggest U.S. company by market capitalization at one point, despite being currently unprofitable.

TRADING FRENZY ENSUED

The turnover in the rocket company's shares, or the approximate dollar value of the day's trades, was consistently highest among large U.S.-listed firms for the first few days.

At one point, it was more than 3.5 times that of Nvidia ([NVDA.O](#)) [↗], which typically leads in terms of turnover.

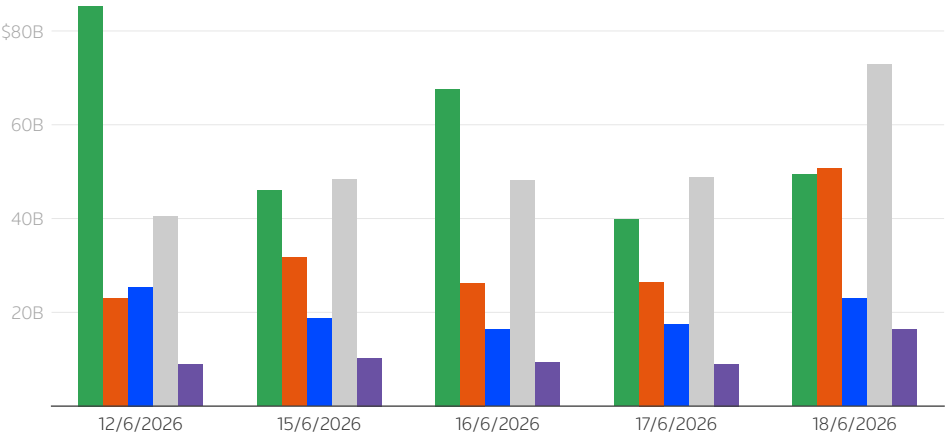
Advertisement · Scroll to continue

AD

SpaceX tops the list of most-active US stocks

Trading volume spiked after debut

● SpaceX ● Nvidia ● Tesla ● Micron Technology ● Alphabet



Note: Values are turnover, in billions of dollars

Source: LSEG | Shashwat Chauhan



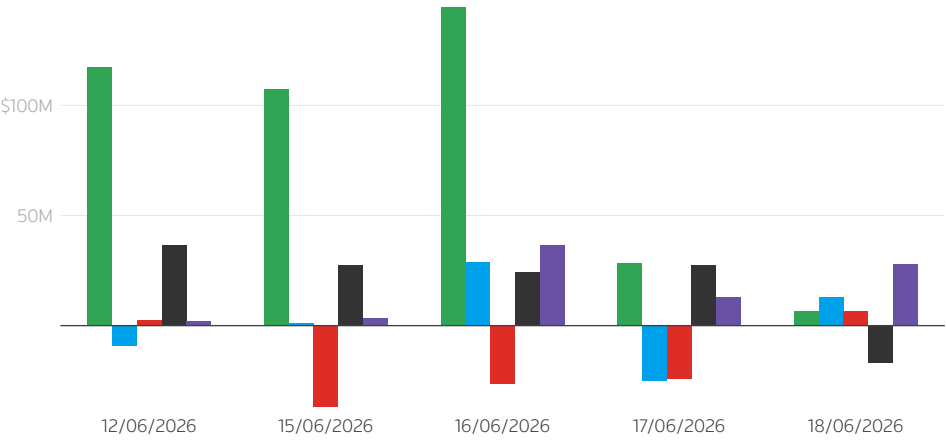
RETAIL TRADERS JUMP IN

SpaceX allocated a record 20% of its IPO shares for retail investors. Traders lapped up millions of dollars' worth of shares and made it one of the most heavily bought stocks last week, according to Vanda Research data. On the day of the debut alone, net buying stood at \$117.6 million - the largest retail net buying for any debut ever.

Retail traders initially lapped up SpaceX

SpaceX was the most sought-after stock among mom-and-pop investors

● SpaceX ● Micron ● Tesla ● Nvidia ● Intel



Note: Values are net buys, in millions of dollars

Source: Vanda | Shashwat Chauhan



OPTIONS TRADING STARTED WITH A BANG

Trading in SpaceX options began on June 16 and it received high interest from investors, with trading volume surging to a record high and bullish activity dominating, underscoring strong demand as investors

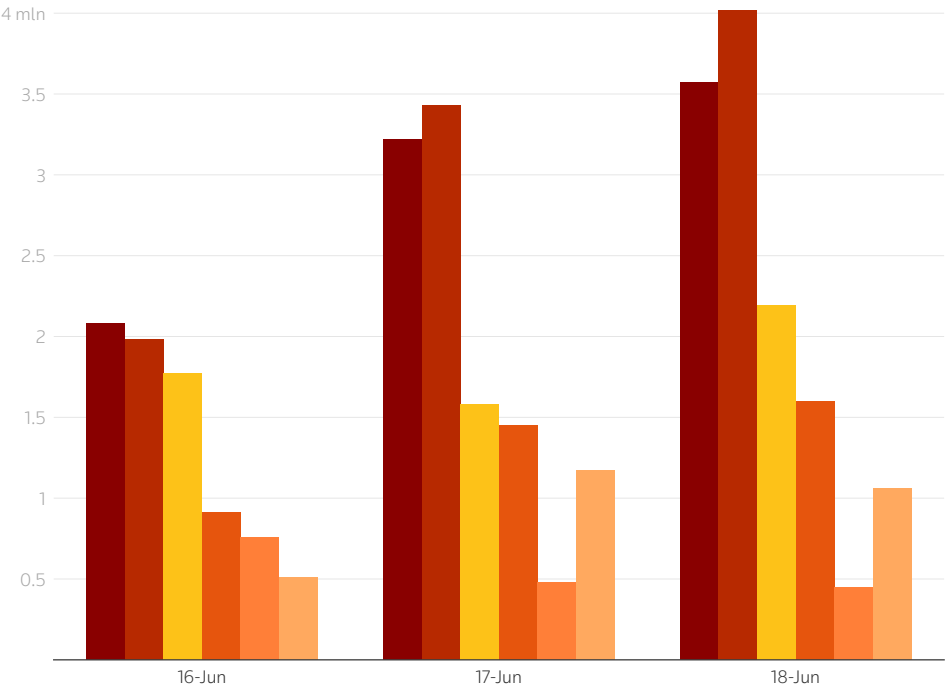
seek avenues for exposure to Musk's new ambitions.

AD

SpaceX joins the options elite

SpaceX options debuted to record demand, trading at levels that put the rocket company in the same league as the most active names on Wall Street

● Tesla ● Nvidia ● SpaceX ● Apple ● Netflix ● Microsoft



Daily options contract volume for some of the companies with the highest daily options volume, June 16-18
Source: Trade Alert | Saqib Ahmed

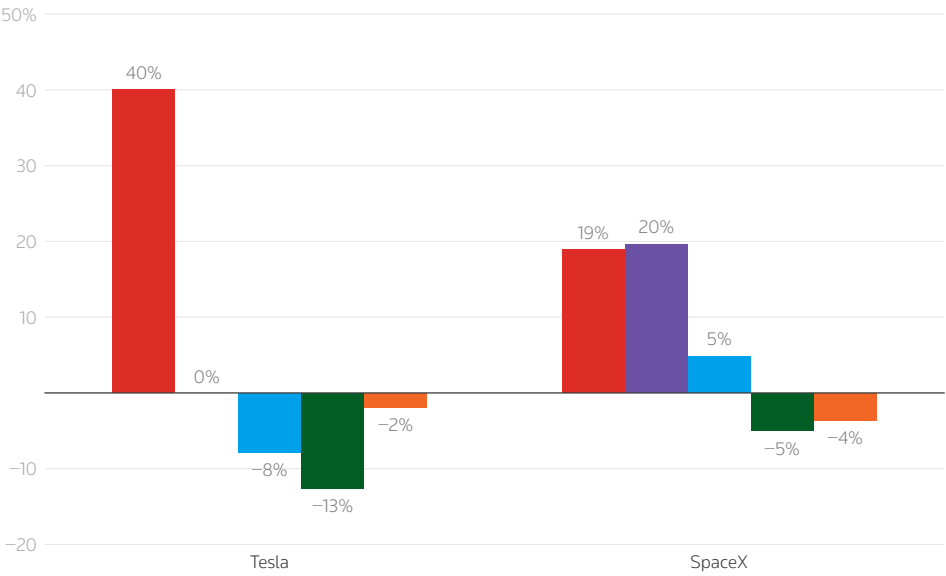
HOW IT FARED COMPARED TO TESLA

SpaceX saw explosive gains in its first three trading sessions, briefly pushing its valuation past Microsoft's (MSFT.Q) to make it the fourth most valuable company in the world.

However, the stock ran into turbulence in the latter half of the week - a reaction that looked similar to that of Tesla (TSLA.Q) at the time of its 2010 debut.

How SpaceX's first five days of trading compares to Tesla's

● Day 1 ● Day 2 ● Day 3 ● Day 4 ● Day 5



Source: LSEG Data | Zaheer Kachwala



Reporting by Shashwat Chauhan, Medha Singh, Zaheer Kachwala in Bengaluru and Saqib Iqbal Ahmed in New York; Editing by Pooja Desai

Our Standards: [The Thomson Reuters Trust Principles.](#)

- Suggested Topics:
- Stocks
- Capital Markets
- ADAS, AV & Safety
- Software-Defined Vehicle
- Sustainable & EV Supply Chain



Purchase Licensing Rights

Read Next / Editor's Picks



Business
SpaceX short selling bets increase after post-debut share selloff



Business
J.P.Morgan raises S&P 500 year-end target to 7,800, joins bullish trend



Business
Wendy's hits over seven-month high as retail traders spark meme-like rally



Business
Anxious investors: Micron earning sector whipsaw

Feedback

